2.3 Global Migration

This topic explores the causes, patterns, and consequences of international migration. It examines migration theories, the impacts on source and host countries, the role of remittances in development, and how migration is managed at national and international levels. Migration is one of the most politically contentious and emotionally charged topics in contemporary geography — strong answers demonstrate nuance, balance, and evidence-based reasoning.

Key Migration Terminology

Migration: The permanent or semi-permanent movement of people from one place to another, involving a change of usual residence. International migration crosses national borders; internal migration occurs within a country (e.g., rural-urban migration). The UN defines an international migrant as a person living outside their country of birth for 12 months or more.

Term	Definition
Emigration	Leaving one's country of origin to live permanently or semi-permanently in another country
Immigration	Moving into a new country to live permanently or semi-permanently
Net migration	Difference between immigration and emigration over a period. Positive net migration = more arrivals than departures (population growth contribution). UK net migration reached a record 745,000 in 2022
Voluntary migration	A free choice to move, typically for economic, educational, or lifestyle reasons (though constrained by structural factors)

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Forced migration	Movement compelled by conflict, persecution, natural disaster, or environmental change. People have no realistic choice but to flee
Refugee	A person who has crossed an international border and has a well-founded fear of persecution based on race, religion, nationality, political opinion, or membership of a particular social group (1951 UN Refugee Convention definition). Legal status confers rights to protection and assistance
Asylum seeker	A person who has applied for refugee status in another country but whose claim has not yet been determined. Not all asylum seekers are granted refugee status
Internally displaced person (IDP)	Forced to flee their home but remains within their own country's borders. IDPs outnumber refugees (estimated 62.5 million globally in 2022) but receive less international attention and legal protection
Economic migrant	A person who moves to another country primarily for better employment, wages, or living standards. Distinguished from refugees in international law, though in practice the boundary is blurred (many migrants face both economic hardship and insecurity)
Diaspora	A scattered population whose origin lies in a different geographical area, maintaining cultural and social connections to their homeland (e.g., Indian diaspora: 18 million; Chinese: 10 million; Jewish, Armenian, Irish diasporas)
Remittances	Money sent by migrants working abroad back to their families and communities in the source country. A major source of development finance for many LICs
Brain drain	Emigration of highly educated and skilled people (doctors, engineers, academics) from a developing country, depleting human capital needed for development
Irregular/undocumented migration	Movement across borders without legal authorisation. Includes visa overstayers, smuggled migrants, and those crossing borders covertly. Estimated 4.2 million undocumented migrants in EU; 11 million in USA

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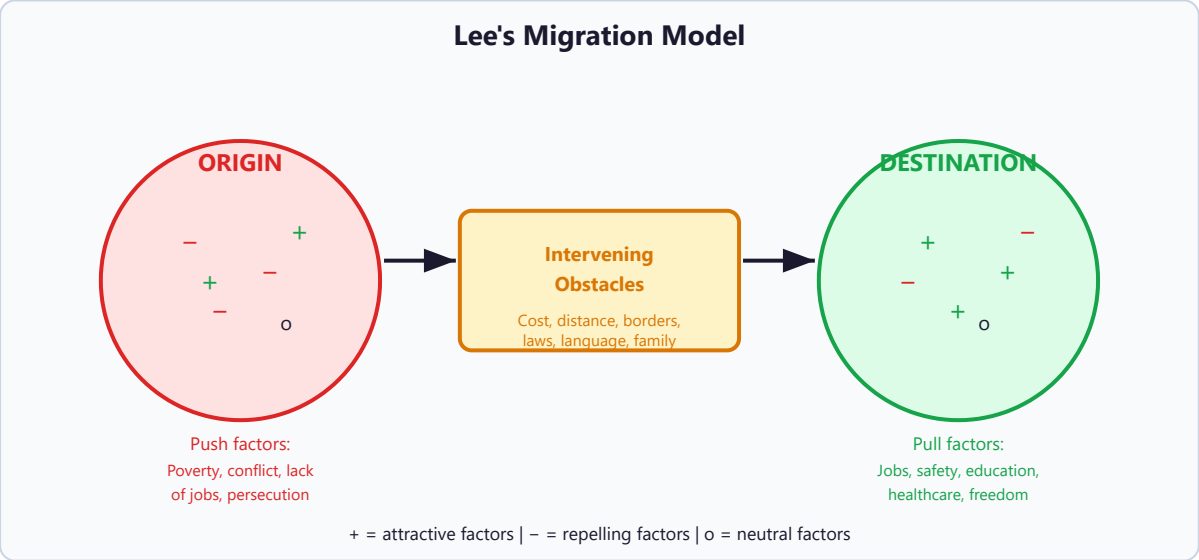
Migration Theories and Models

Lee's Migration Model (1966)

Everett Lee proposed that migration decisions are influenced by four interacting sets of factors:

- **Factors at the origin:** Both positive (family, community, familiarity) and negative (poverty, conflict, lack of opportunity) characteristics that influence the decision to leave
- **Factors at the destination:** Both attractive (jobs, safety, freedom) and deterrent (discrimination, culture shock, high cost of living) characteristics
- **Intervening obstacles:** Barriers between origin and destination — physical distance, cost of travel, immigration laws, border controls, language, cultural differences, family ties
- **Personal factors:** Individual characteristics that affect migration propensity — age (young adults most mobile), education level, gender, risk tolerance, family circumstances, access to information and networks. Migration is selective: it is not the poorest or least educated who typically migrate internationally but those with some resources, education, and social capital



Ravenstein's Laws of Migration (1885)

One of the earliest systematic attempts to describe migration patterns. Many observations remain valid:

- Most migrants move only a short distance; long-distance migrants tend to move to major economic centres
- Each migration flow produces a compensating counter-flow (return migration, replacement migration)

- Urban residents are less likely to migrate than rural residents (urbanites have more opportunity locally)
- Females are more likely to migrate within their country (short-distance); males historically dominated international migration (though this is changing — women now constitute ~48% of international migrants)
- Economic factors are the dominant cause of migration
- Migration increases with development of transport and communication technologies

Todaro's Model of Rural-Urban Migration (1969)

Michael Todaro argued that rural-urban migration in developing countries is driven by the *expected* income differential between rural and urban areas, accounting for the probability of finding employment. Migrants move even when urban unemployment is high because the expected urban wage (wage × probability of employment) exceeds guaranteed but very low rural income. This explains the apparent paradox of continued rural-urban migration to cities with high unemployment and growing slums.

World Systems Theory and Migration

Wallerstein's world systems theory (applied to migration by Sassen, Massey, and others) argues that migration flows follow the logic of global capitalism: labour moves from the periphery (LICs) to the core (HICs) because capitalist penetration of peripheral economies disrupts traditional livelihoods (through land enclosure, mechanisation of agriculture, TNC investment), creating a displaced population. Simultaneously, core economies demand cheap, flexible labour for low-wage service and manufacturing sectors. Migration is therefore structurally embedded in the global economic system, not simply a matter of individual choice.

Exam Tip: Migration is rarely caused by a single push or pull factor — it is always a complex combination of economic, social, political, and environmental drivers. Show this complexity in your essays. Also emphasise that migration is selective: it is not the poorest who migrate internationally (they lack the resources), but those with some education, savings, and access to social networks. This is why remittances flow to middle-income developing countries more than to the poorest ones.

Push and Pull Factors in Detail

Category	Push Factors (Origin)	Pull Factors (Destination)

Economic	Poverty, unemployment, low wages, underemployment, subsistence agriculture, economic crisis, lack of investment	Higher wages, job availability (especially in sectors with labour shortages), career prospects, better standard of living, entrepreneurial opportunities
Social	Poor healthcare, limited educational opportunities, gender discrimination, family separation, poor housing, lack of social mobility	Better healthcare (e.g., NHS), quality education, family reunification, established diaspora communities providing support networks, social freedoms
Political	War, civil conflict, political persecution, authoritarian governance, corruption, lack of rule of law, ethnic cleansing	Political stability, democracy, rule of law, human rights protection, asylum systems, freedom of expression and religion
Environmental	Natural disasters (earthquakes, floods, droughts), climate change (sea-level rise, desertification, water scarcity), land degradation, deforestation	More favourable climate, environmental security, available agricultural land, access to clean water

Global Migration Patterns and Scale

Key Statistics and Trends

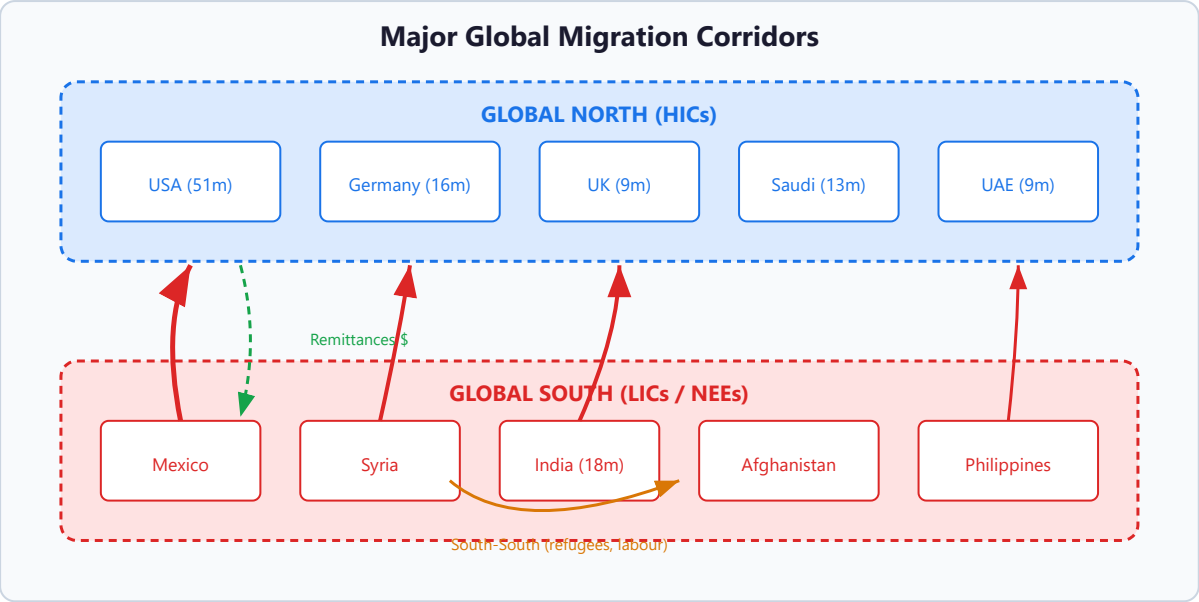
- Approximately **281 million international migrants** globally (2020, UN DESA) — 3.6% of world population. This number has more than tripled since 1970 (84 million)
- Most migrants move from developing to developed countries, but **South-South migration** is also very significant — roughly 40% of all international migration is between developing countries
- **Top destination countries:** USA (~51 million foreign-born), Germany (~16 million), Saudi Arabia (~13 million), Russia (~12 million), UK (~9 million), UAE (~9 million)
- **Top source countries:** India (~18 million abroad), Mexico (~11 million), Russia (~11 million), China (~10 million), Syria (~8 million, largely refugees)
- **Forcibly displaced:** 108.4 million people worldwide forcibly displaced by end of 2022 (UNHCR) — highest ever recorded. Includes 35.3 million refugees, 62.5 million IDPs, and 5.4 million asylum seekers.

Major source countries: Afghanistan (8.2 million), Syria (6.5 million), Ukraine (5.7 million), Venezuela (5.6 million), South Sudan (2.3 million)

- **Labour migration:** 169 million international migrant workers (ILO, 2022). Concentrated in services (66%), industry (27%), and agriculture (7%). The Gulf states (UAE, Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Kuwait) are particularly dependent on migrant labour — in Qatar and UAE, migrants outnumber citizens by 4:1
- **Feminisation of migration:** Women now constitute ~48% of international migrants (up from ~35% in 1960). Many migrate independently for employment (nursing, domestic work, manufacturing), not just as dependants joining male migrants

Types of Migration Flow

Flow	Description	Example
South to North	LICs/NEEs to HICs; predominantly economic migration, though also refugees	Mexico/Central America to USA; North/West Africa to EU; South Asia to Gulf states and UK
South to South	Between developing countries; often refugees or regional economic migration. Accounts for ~40% of international migration	Syrian refugees to Turkey/Lebanon/Jordan; Bangladeshis/Nepalis to Gulf states; Venezuelans to Colombia/Peru; Zimbabweans to South Africa
North to North	Between developed countries; typically highly skilled workers, students, lifestyle migrants	UK professionals to Australia/Canada; EU freedom of movement (pre-Brexit: Poles to UK, Germans to Austria)
North to South	Retirement migration; skilled professionals; aid and development workers; corporate expatriates	British/German retirees to Spain/Portugal; international development workers in Africa/Asia; corporate expats in Singapore/Dubai



Impacts of Migration

Impacts on Source (Origin) Countries

Positive	Negative
Remittances boost household income and national GDP. India receives $100+ billion/year in remittances — the highest in the world. Remittances to the Philippines ($36 billion) = ~9% of GDP	Brain drain: loss of educated, skilled, working-age people needed for development. Sub-Saharan Africa has lost ~20,000 health professionals/year to HICs; 1 in 4 doctors trained in Africa works overseas
Reduces pressure on jobs, housing, and resources in areas of high unemployment	Labour shortages in key sectors: farming, healthcare, education. Moldova has lost ~25% of its working-age population to emigration
Return migrants bring back skills, capital, business experience, and new ideas ("brain circulation"). Chinese returnees have driven tech entrepreneurship in Beijing and Shenzhen	Family separation: children raised without parents. In Moldova and Philippines, "social orphans" grow up in the care of grandparents while parents work abroad
Diaspora networks facilitate trade, investment, cultural exchange, and political advocacy for the	Dependency on remittances: communities may rely on external income rather than developing productive

home country	local economies. Remittances are often spent on consumption (food, housing, vehicles) rather than productive investment
Reduced unemployment and underemployment; social safety valve reducing political pressure	Demographic imbalance: ageing population, gender imbalance if predominantly young men leave. Rural areas of Eastern Europe (Romania, Bulgaria, Latvia) face population collapse

Impacts on Host (Destination) Countries

Positive	Negative
Fill labour shortages in critical sectors. UK NHS employs 170,000+ non-British nationals (~13% of staff); 26% of NHS doctors qualified overseas. Agriculture, construction, hospitality, and social care all depend on migrant labour	Perceived pressure on public services (housing, schools, healthcare). Evidence is mixed: migrants also pay taxes and use fewer services per capita than natives, but impacts are concentrated in specific areas
Cultural diversity and enrichment: food, music, art, languages, festivals, perspectives. 40% of London's restaurants are run by migrants	Social tensions and community cohesion challenges: racism, xenophobia, far-right populism. Anti-immigration sentiment contributed to Brexit vote and rise of populist parties across Europe
Entrepreneurship: migrants disproportionately start businesses. In the UK, 1 in 7 companies is founded by a migrant. In the USA, 55% of $1bn+ startups have at least one immigrant founder	Potential wage depression in low-skilled sectors (debated — Bank of England estimated immigration had a small negative effect on wages at the bottom, but other studies find no significant impact)
Net fiscal contribution: studies show EU migrants to the UK paid 34% more in taxes than they received in benefits (UCL, 2014). Young working-age migrants are net fiscal contributors	Integration challenges: language barriers, cultural differences, spatial segregation, parallel communities. Second-generation identity tensions
Address ageing population: working-age migrants support pension systems, care for the elderly, and	Political backlash: rise of anti-immigration parties and movements (UKIP/Brexit Party in UK, AfD in

boost birth rates. Without migration, Germany's working-age population would shrink by 30% by 2060	Germany, Rassemblement National in France, Vox in Spain). Migration has become the most divisive political issue in many HICs
Innovation and skill diversity: skilled migrants bring expertise, international networks, and fresh perspectives. Silicon Valley was built substantially by immigrant engineers and entrepreneurs	Brain waste: skilled migrants trapped in low-skilled jobs (e.g., doctors driving taxis, engineers cleaning offices) due to non-recognition of qualifications or discrimination

Case Study: EU Migration to the UK (Pre- and Post-Brexit)

Following EU enlargement in 2004 (A8 accession states including Poland, Czech Republic, Lithuania, Latvia, Slovakia, Hungary, Estonia, Slovenia), the UK was one of only three EU members (with Ireland and Sweden) to grant immediate freedom of movement:

- **Scale:** Net migration to the UK peaked at ~330,000/year in 2015. By 2019, ~3.7 million EU nationals were living in the UK (6% of the population). The Polish-born population grew from 58,000 (2001) to 832,000 (2019), making Polish the most common non-English language in England
- **Economic contribution:** EU migrants filled critical labour shortages in agriculture (90% of seasonal workers from EU), construction (30% of London's construction workforce), healthcare (65,000 EU nationals in the NHS), food processing, and hospitality. A UCL study (2014) found EU migrants paid 34% more in taxes than they received in public services. They contributed net $26 billion to UK public finances over 2001–2011
- **Social and cultural impacts:** Cultural diversity enriched cities — Polish shops, Romanian restaurants, Portuguese cafes became features of high streets across the UK. Polish Saturday schools established for children; new church congregations formed. But: in some areas (Boston, Lincolnshire: 16% Eastern European by 2011), rapid demographic change caused local tensions over housing, school places, and healthcare waiting times
- **Political consequences:** Immigration was consistently cited as the top concern by Leave voters in the 2016 EU referendum. The perception (not always supported by evidence) that migration depressed wages, strained services, and changed communities was politically potent. The slogan "Take Back Control" resonated with voters who felt powerless over demographic change
- **Post-Brexit:** Freedom of movement ended on 1 January 2021. A points-based immigration system was introduced, requiring a minimum salary threshold ($25,600), a job offer from an approved sponsor, and English language competence. Net EU migration turned negative briefly in

2020–21 as departures exceeded arrivals. Severe labour shortages subsequently emerged in agriculture (crops rotting unharvested), hospitality, logistics (HGV driver shortage), social care, and food processing — demonstrating the UK economy's structural dependence on migrant labour

Case Study: Syrian Refugee Crisis (2011–present)

The Syrian civil war (from March 2011) produced the largest refugee crisis since World War II:

- **Scale:** 6.5 million Syrian refugees abroad; 6.9 million internally displaced; ~13.5 million Syrians (60% of pre-war population) in need of humanitarian assistance. Before the war, Syria had 22 million people; its population has shrunk to ~18 million
- **Neighbouring host countries bear the greatest burden:** Turkey hosts 3.6 million Syrian refugees (largest refugee population of any country globally); Lebanon 1.5 million (~25% of pre-crisis population — the highest per capita refugee population in the world); Jordan 670,000; Iraq 260,000; Egypt 145,000
- **Impact on Turkey:** $40+ billion spent on hosting refugees. Most refugees live in urban areas (only 2% in camps), working in the informal economy at below minimum wage. Social tensions between Turks and Syrians, particularly as Turkey's economy deteriorated. Turkey received $6 billion from the EU under a 2016 deal to restrict onward migration to Europe
- **Impact on Lebanon:** With refugees equivalent to ~25% of its pre-crisis population, Lebanon faced extreme strain on infrastructure (water, electricity, sewage, waste management) that was already fragile. No formal refugee camps — most Syrians live in urban areas or informal tented settlements. Youth unemployment exceeded 35%; wages fell 30–50% for low-skilled Lebanese workers. The crisis contributed to Lebanon's 2019 economic collapse and political crisis
- **European crisis (2015):** Over 1 million migrants and refugees crossed the Mediterranean to Europe in 2015, many via Turkey to Greece. Germany's Chancellor Merkel adopted an "open door" policy, admitting 890,000 asylum seekers in 2015 alone (Germany has since processed and integrated the majority, with 50%+ in employment by 2020). Other countries closed borders: Hungary built a fence, several countries suspended Schengen free movement. The EU-Turkey deal (March 2016) dramatically reduced crossings but was criticised for effectively trapping refugees in Turkey and Greece
- **Mediterranean deaths:** IOM estimates 25,000+ people have died or gone missing attempting Mediterranean crossings since 2014. The deadliest year was 2016 (5,143 deaths). Smuggler

networks charge $3,000–$6,000 per person for dangerous crossings in overcrowded inflatable dinghies

- **Key lesson:** 85% of the world's refugees are hosted by developing countries, not by wealthy nations. The narrative that Europe faces the greatest burden is not supported by the data. This raises fundamental questions about global responsibility-sharing and the adequacy of international frameworks

Migration and Development

Remittances

Remittances: Money sent by migrants working abroad back to their families and communities in the source country. In 2022, global remittances to low- and middle-income countries reached approximately $626 billion — more than three times total official development assistance (ODA, ~$185 billion) and exceeding FDI to many LICs. Remittances are the largest source of external finance for many developing countries.

Top remittance-receiving countries (2022):

- India: $100 billion (but only ~3% of GDP due to India's large economy)
- Mexico: $60 billion (~5% of GDP)
- China: $51 billion
- Philippines: $36 billion (~9% of GDP)
- Egypt: $32 billion (~8% of GDP)
- Tonga, Tajikistan, and Nepal receive the most remittances as a share of GDP (30–50%), demonstrating extreme dependency

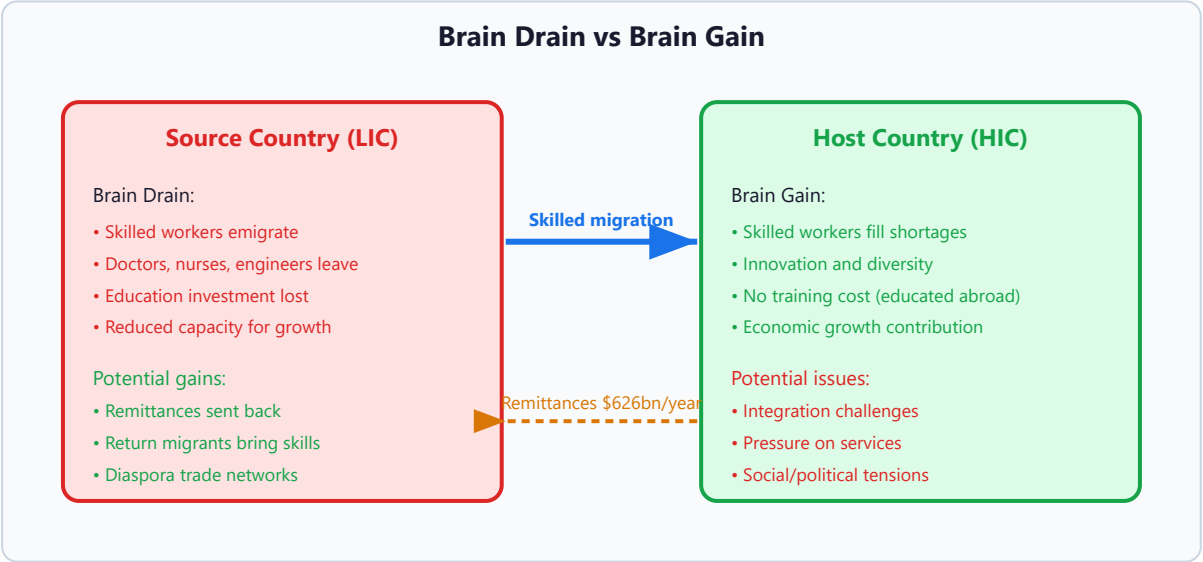
Positive developmental impacts:

- Direct poverty reduction — improve living standards, nutrition, and housing for receiving families
- Fund education (school fees, books, uniforms) and healthcare spending, building human capital
- Multiplier effect in local economies: remittance spending supports local businesses and services

- More stable than other capital flows (FDI, portfolio investment, aid) — continue during economic downturns and natural disasters when other flows decline. During COVID-19, remittances fell only 1.6% vs FDI declining 35%
- Can fund small business investment, housing construction, and agricultural improvements

Limitations and criticisms:

- Often spent on consumption (food, consumer goods, weddings, funerals) rather than productive investment that would generate long-term growth
- Can create inequality between remittance-receiving households and those without a migrant abroad
- Dependency: communities and even governments rely on remittances rather than developing local economic capacity. If migration stops (e.g., Gulf state job losses during COVID), income collapses
- Transfer fees remain high: global average ~6.3% (2022), far above the UN SDG target of 3%. Costs are highest for Africa (~8%). This means ~$40 billion/year is lost to intermediaries
- Brain drain: the most productive workers leave, reducing the country's own economic capacity even as their remittances flow back



Migration Management

National Immigration Policies

Policy Type	Description	Example

Points-based system	Migrants scored on skills, qualifications, language proficiency, age, and salary; only those above a threshold are admitted. Designed to attract skilled workers while controlling numbers	UK (post-Brexit, 2021); Australia (since 1989); Canada (Express Entry system)
Quota system	Set numerical limits on migrants admitted per year or per category	USA green card lottery (55,000 diversity visas/year); Switzerland votes on immigration quotas
Freedom of movement	Citizens of member states can live and work in any other member state without visas or work permits	EU/EEA (445 million people); ECOWAS in West Africa (400 million people)
Guest worker programmes	Temporary work permits for specific sectors; workers expected to return after a defined period. Often restrict family reunification and access to permanent residence	Gulf states' kafala (sponsorship) system — workers tied to a single employer, limiting mobility and rights; Germany's Gastarbeiter programme (1955–1973, initially for Turkish workers)
Border enforcement	Physical barriers, surveillance technology, patrols, and detection systems to prevent unauthorised entry	USA-Mexico border wall ($15 billion+ cost); Hungary's razor-wire border fence (2015); Frontex (EU border and coast guard agency, budget $900 million/year); UK Channel patrols
Offshore/third-country processing	Processing asylum claims outside the destination country to deter arrivals	Australia's offshore detention (Nauru, Manus Island — widely condemned for inhumane conditions); UK-Rwanda scheme (declared unlawful by UK Supreme Court in 2023); EU-Turkey deal

International Frameworks

- **1951 UN Refugee Convention (and 1967 Protocol):** Defines who qualifies as a refugee and establishes their rights. Core principle of non-refoulement: states cannot return refugees to a country where they face persecution. 149 states are signatories. However: the Convention does not cover IDPs,

climate migrants, or people fleeing generalised violence (only individual persecution). Written for post-WWII Europe, it is increasingly inadequate for 21st-century displacement

- **UNHCR (UN High Commissioner for Refugees):** The UN's refugee agency, responsible for protection, shelter, and assistance. Operates in 135 countries with 18,000 staff. Funded almost entirely by voluntary contributions ($10.7 billion budget, 2023), creating chronic funding shortfalls
- **Global Compact on Safe, Orderly, and Regular Migration (2018):** Non-binding UN framework with 23 objectives including protecting migrants' rights, reducing irregular migration, combating smuggling and trafficking, and facilitating legal migration pathways. The USA, Hungary, Australia, and several other countries refused to sign
- **International Organization for Migration (IOM):** Provides operational assistance, policy guidance, and data on migration. Leads responses to migration crises

Case Study: USA-Mexico Migration Corridor

One of the world's largest and most politically contentious migration corridors:

- **Scale:** ~11 million Mexican-born migrants in USA (plus an estimated 5–6 million undocumented). An additional ~3 million Central American migrants transit through Mexico (Northern Triangle: Guatemala, Honduras, El Salvador)
- **Push factors from Mexico/Central America:** Poverty (40% of Mexicans below national poverty line; 60%+ in Honduras and Guatemala); gang violence (Honduras had the world's highest murder rate, 90/100,000 in 2012); corruption; drug cartel control of regions; subsistence agriculture unable to compete with subsidised US corn (NAFTA/USMCA removed tariffs but US corn subsidies remained, devastating Mexican smallholders); climate change impacts on agriculture
- **Pull factors in USA:** Wages 5–10x higher than Mexico; job availability in agriculture (70%+ of US farm workers are foreign-born), construction, food processing, domestic service, and hospitality; established Mexican-American communities (37 million Hispanic Americans of Mexican descent); proximity; family reunification
- **Economic impact on USA:** Mexican migrants contribute $600+ billion to US GDP. Fill essential labour shortages in sectors Americans avoid. Pay ~$12 billion/year in taxes. But: some evidence of modest wage depression for native-born workers without high school diplomas
- **Remittances to Mexico:** $63 billion in 2023 — Mexico's largest source of foreign income, exceeding oil revenues and tourism. Equivalent to ~5% of GDP. Sustain rural communities in states like Michoacan, Oaxaca, and Guerrero where formal employment is scarce

- **Political controversy:** Trump's border wall ($15 billion allocated; ~450 miles built); "Remain in Mexico" policy (asylum seekers forced to wait in Mexico); family separation policy (2018, ~5,500 children separated from parents, provoking international condemnation); DACA (Deferred Action for Childhood Arrivals, protecting 800,000 "Dreamers" brought to USA as children — legal status remains uncertain). Migration is consistently a top-3 political issue in US elections
- **Transit migration crisis:** Hundreds of thousands of Central Americans, Venezuelans, Haitians, and others now transit through Mexico annually, many via the dangerous Darien Gap (Panama-Colombia jungle crossing). An increasing share of migrants at the US-Mexico border are not Mexican but from more distant countries

Climate Change and Migration

Environmental/climate migrants: People displaced by environmental change including sea-level rise, drought, desertification, flooding, and extreme weather events. There is no agreed international legal definition, and climate migrants are NOT recognised as "refugees" under the 1951 Convention — a critical gap in international law.

- The World Bank (Groundswell Report, 2021) estimates that **216 million people could be internally displaced by climate change by 2050** across six world regions, under a pessimistic but plausible scenario. Sub-Saharan Africa (86 million), South Asia (40 million), and Latin America (17 million) would be most affected
- **Sea-level rise:** Low-lying island nations face existential threat. Tuvalu (population 11,000, highest point 4.6 m) and Kiribati (120,000) may become uninhabitable within decades. The Maldives (500,000, 80% of land <1 m above sea level) is investing in artificial land and negotiating contingency migration agreements with Australia and India. Bangladesh: a 1 m sea-level rise would inundate 17% of the country and displace 20+ million people from the densely populated delta
- **Desertification:** The Sahel region is experiencing increasing drought, pushing pastoralist and agricultural communities southward. Lake Chad has shrunk by 90% since the 1960s, displacing millions and contributing to instability (Boko Haram recruits from displaced populations)
- **Extreme weather events:** Climate change is increasing the frequency and intensity of hurricanes, floods, wildfires, and droughts. On average, 21.5 million people are displaced by weather-related events

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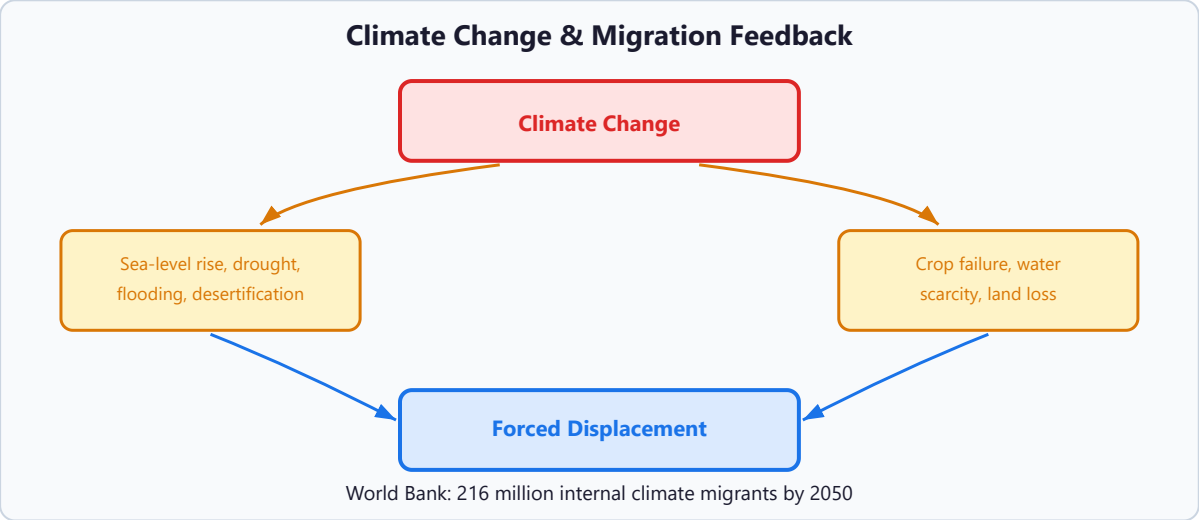
each year (IDMC). Most displacement is internal and temporary, but cumulative impacts erode livelihoods and drive permanent migration

- **Key governance gap:** No international legal framework specifically protects climate migrants. The Nansen Initiative (2012–2015) and its successor, the Platform on Disaster Displacement, have developed non-binding guidelines but enforcement remains absent. Some countries (New Zealand, Australia) have explored climate visa categories but none yet exist in law
- **Climate justice dimension:** The populations most affected by climate-induced displacement have contributed least to the emissions causing climate change. The 48 Least Developed Countries produce ~1% of global CO_2 emissions but face the greatest displacement risk



Exam Tip: Migration questions require balanced, nuanced evaluation. Always discuss impacts on BOTH source AND host countries, consider different perspectives (economic, social, cultural, political, environmental), and use specific case study data with real numbers. For essay questions, address: Who benefits from migration and who loses? Is migration positive or negative overall, and for whom? At what scale are you analysing (individual, household, community, national, global)? Show awareness that migration is a complex, contested issue with no simple answers — simplistic "migration is good" or "migration is bad" conclusions will not score highly. The strongest answers integrate multiple case studies, reference migration theories (Lee, Ravenstein, Todaro), and consider the structural causes of migration (inequality, colonialism, globalisation) rather than treating it as a simple matter of individual choice.